One packed stream a partition in the folded build: same-session A/B with its own A/A

One `ic` binary (`332b380f…`, built at `9ffb571245` with `--features scan-probes`) and three labels a round:

- **a** and **q**: `KIC_FOLD_PACK=0`, two streams a partition (a hash and a stored word);
- **p**: the default, one `u64` a pair, with the orbit in hash bits 34–37 and the partition's top eight.

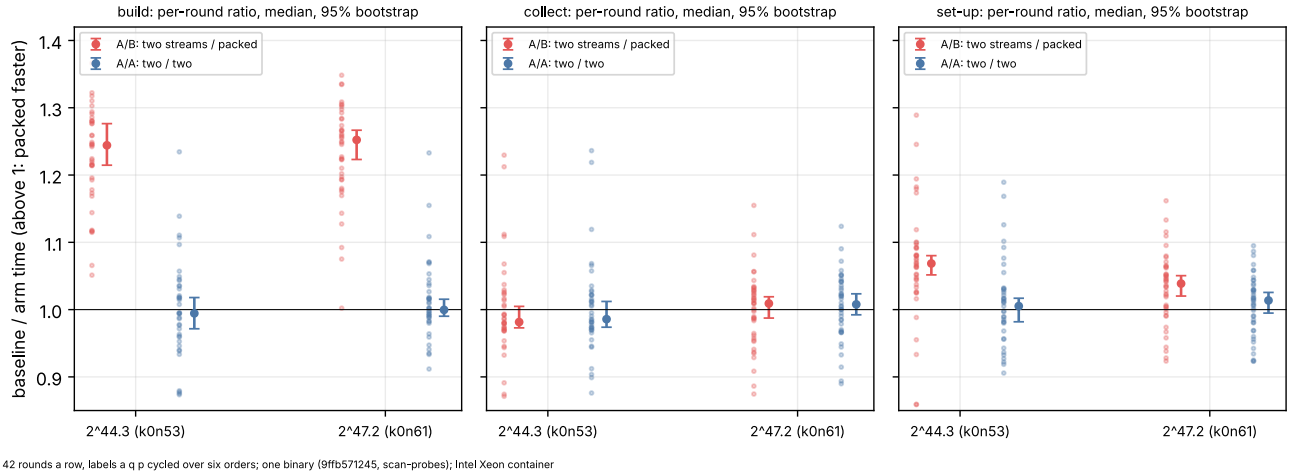
Rows are suite `M1-T01` at `k0n53` (2^44.3) and `k0n61` (2^47.2). There are 42 rounds, cycled over the six orders. Each process ran under `isolated_bench --cpus 2` with `RAYON_NUM_THREADS=1` on this session's container (Intel Xeon @ 2.1 GHz, AVX-512). The busy gate refused 132 launches, which were retried and are not measurements. `PROTOCOL.md` was committed before any row. Tables are identical word for word, by construction and by test.

Identity

Zero mismatches. One k0n53 round was dropped as contended, leaving 41 and 42 rounds.

Result (median of per-round ratios a/p, 95% bootstrap over rounds)

row	metric	A/B (two / packed)	A/A (two / two)	verdict; prediction
k0n53	**build**	**1.244** [1.214, 1.276]	0.994 [0.971, 1.017]	**established**; [1.08, 1.25]: held
k0n53	**set-up**	**1.068** [1.051, 1.080]	1.005 [0.981, 1.016]	**established**; [1.00, 1.07]: held
k0n53	collect	0.981 [0.972, 1.004]	0.985 [0.973, 1.012]	no regression; [0.97, 1.03]: held
k0n61	**build**	**1.252** [1.223, 1.266]	0.999 [0.990, 1.015]	**established**; [1.08, 1.25]: missed high
k0n61	set-up	1.038 [1.020, 1.050]	1.013 [0.994, 1.025]	not established (1.020 < 1.025); [1.00, 1.04]: held
k0n61	collect	1.009 [0.987, 1.019]	1.007 [0.992, 1.023]	no regression; [0.97, 1.03]: held



Mechanism: build steps, ns per stored pair (median over rounds)

step	k0n53 two	k0n53 packed	k0n61 two	k0n61 packed
stream push	13.28	**7.11**	14.83	**7.90**
counting sort + filter fill	9.04	9.39	9.43	10.00
additions + keys	7.33	7.29	7.95	8.03
whole	31.25	24.70	33.08	26.89

The push halves. The fill pays about 0.4–0.6 ns to rebuild each stored word from its hash.

Decision (frozen rule)

The build gain is established at both sizes, and no collect regression is established. So packing stays the default. The whole set-up is established faster at k0n53 (6.8%), the first set-up gain in this series to clear its A/A. At k0n61 its lower end (1.020) misses the A/A's upper end (1.025).

Scope

A component result on this host class. It is not a cold-time claim against rho, and no board row follows from it (validation gate). Tables, answers and counted work are unchanged, so no recorded session's replay changes.